



FAIRFIELD, IOWA

Virtually Tour Our Community

Fairfield, Iowa, is a community that uniquely blends classic Midwestern charm with a progressive, globally-minded spirit. Here at the crossroads of tradition and innovation, you'll discover a town renowned for its dynamic arts and culture, its thriving entrepreneurial ecosystem, and its dedication to wellness and [sustainable living](#). From the vibrant energy of our historic town square and year-round farmers market to the world-class performances at the Fairfield Arts and Convention Center is a place of creative and conscious living. We invite you to explore our friendly neighborhoods, connect with our innovative community, and experience the warm, inclusive atmosphere that makes Fairfield a truly remarkable place to visit or call home.





FEATURES OF FAIRFIELD

Highlights of Our Community

Economy

We have a vibrant startup community that includes 400 small businesses that provide jobs to 3,000 people. Many business owners and leaders are homegrown alumni from our school, and they have raised a combined \$200 million in venture capital. Our residents are big believers in giving back to the community, Fairfield's Jefferson County ranks fifth among all U.S. counties in per-capita charitable contributions.

Sustainability

The Fairfield Go-Green Sustainability Commission was born in 2009. It's a community-wide plan to incorporate [sustainable practices](#) throughout the city that has resulted in many all-green buildings and huge impacts in the areas of energy, transportation, and infrastructure. Fairfield has one of

America's largest concentrations of solar homes, and our EcoVillage is a community of permaculture homes that run completely on solar and wind power. Our town has a deep commitment to sustainability that has led to a boost in organic farming, which allows us to offer fresh farm-to-table food on campus and has made Fairfield, Iowa, the 5th largest market for organic foods in the country.

Culture

Fairfield has become Iowa's foremost arts center, with over 10 galleries and art venues. The Stephen Sondheim Center for the Performing Arts is centrally located in downtown Fairfield and is a 500-seat theater which hosts a wide range of plays, musicals, and other events. We also have a robust monthly Art Walk during warmer months that attracts visitors from all over the state. It's not uncommon to meet people who drove from nearby states just to come to the ever-popular Art Walk!

Parks & Recreation

Fairfield offers students and community members many opportunities for recreation, including a 33-mile trail system perfect for walking, jogging, biking, and cross-country skiing in the winter. The network connects lakes, prairies, woodlands, wetlands, and a state preserve. In addition, 10 beautiful parks offer facilities including a fresh-water swimming lake with a sandy beach, playgrounds, shelters, picnic areas, and more.

Recognition

Named one of America's best small towns to visit by *Smithsonian Magazine*, Fairfield is big on culture and thriving on creativity. Fairfield lives like a metropolitan community, earning distinctions such as one of Iowa's "Great Places" and being dubbed "America's most unusual town" by Oprah. BuzzFeed calls Fairfield one of "11 Coolest Small Cities It's Time To Road Trip To."

Take a look at this recent issue of [The lowan](#) for a glimpse for our community and all of its offerings.

AROUND THE TOWN

Local Favorites

Cafe Paradiso

Cafe Paradiso was born out of one man's pure passion for great espresso. Owner Steve Giacomini has created his own unique blend of organic, shade-grown coffee beans, which he roasts daily on-site.

Cafe Paradiso is also a haven for artists and musicians. The dining room displays the talents of various artists and our stage provides a chance to hear both locally and internationally known musicians of all kinds.

Golden Magnolia Sanctuary

Golden Magnolia Sanctuary is a rural resilience hub grounded in community ownership, connectivity, and skill sharing. They are a safe space for community members to find sanctuary from hunger, foster creative connections, hold events, & play.

A community supported space for all.

IconArt Gallery

ICONART Gallery is a space for creative exploration, a welcoming environment for like-minded people, and a place where new ideas are born. Their mission is to acquaint you with the very best in contemporary sacred art, interpreting the long and rich tradition of historic art forms within the context of modern culture and contemporary art trends.

Fairfield Farmers Market

The Fairfield, Iowa Farmers Market is a vibrant hub offering a diverse array of locally grown produce, baked goods, crafts, and prepared foods. Known for its organic and specialty items like gluten-free options, the market provides a lively atmosphere often enhanced by live music. It operates year-round, with an outdoor season at [Howard Park](#) from May through October on Wednesdays & Saturdays, and an indoor season on Saturdays from November through April.

Our Mission

To create an innovative Consciousness-Based educational environment where students think deeply and become creative, compassionate, contributing citizens of the world.

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